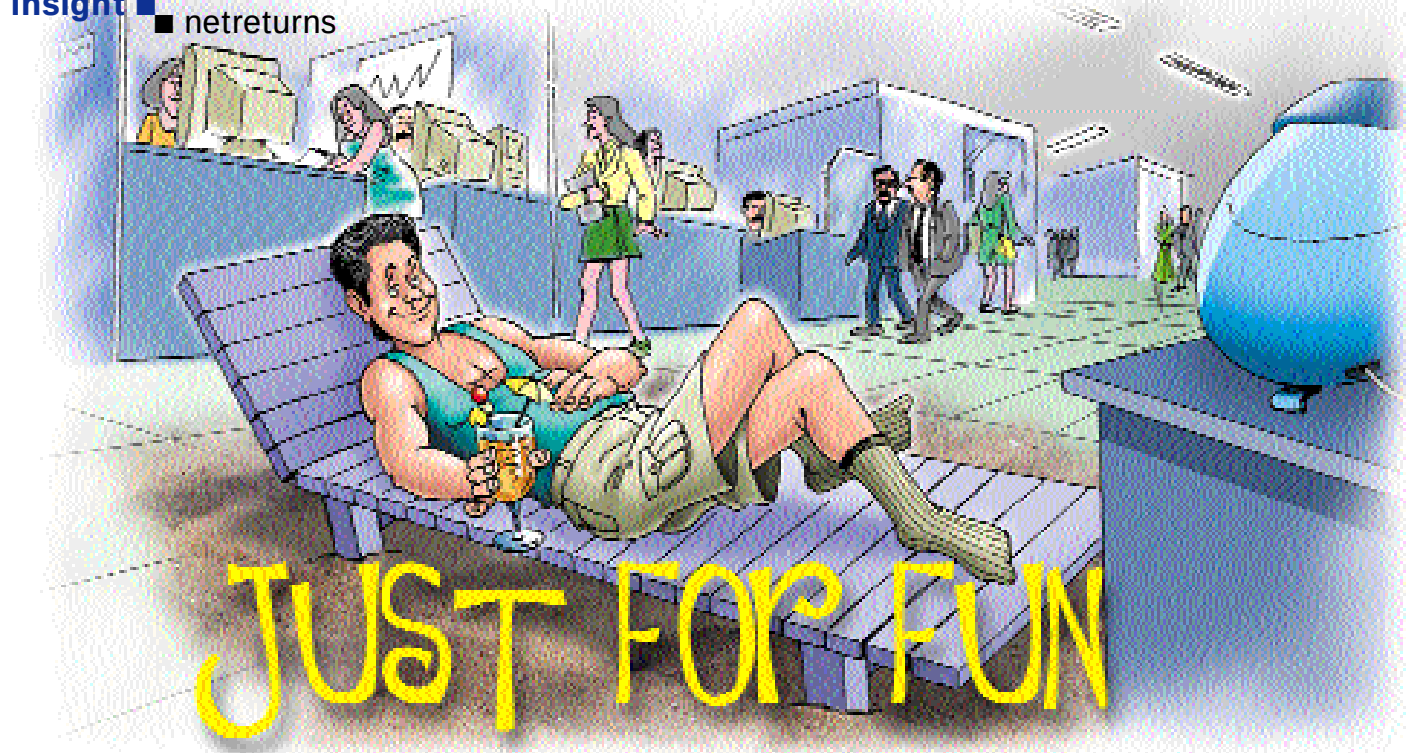




A journey away from boredom

When your work starts creeping into your dreams and weekends mean boring yourself with the TV, you need to take a break and hang loose. Studies show that our concentration levels on any task begins to dip after every 45 minutes. A short break can be fun in many ways and is definitely better than staring blankly at the monitor, forcing your mind to make sense of those crowded worksheets. You don't need to plan a holiday or even spend too much time on your break. Here's what I do for a bit of relaxation when the boss isn't looking.

Brainteasers

11.30 am and the brain is already dead...

I can't find a better place to start my journey than www.bored.com. I put on the online radio from here and check out the list of new wacky sites they've dug up. Now I've got a roadmap for my little excursions from work.

First stop, a little intellectual stimulation with crosswords at www.webcrosswords.com. Most of the clues are about movies, so they should be easy to solve—I don't need to call out to my Thesaurus-quoting colleague every 5 minutes.

I've finished one crossword and decide to give another go at that project proposal. But the words are still a jumble, so I want to look for something even more invigorating—maybe a little philosophy will wake me up. I set the co-ordinates of my astromobile to www.crazythoughts.com to look up some of life's unanswered questions. Now here's a thought-provoking one: If you stick stickers on non-stick pans, do they stick? I'm going to find the answer to this one the moment I reach home! There are more such brainteasers at www.straightdope.com. This one sounds funny: if all 1 billion Chinese jumped at once, would the earth be thrown out of its orbit? The answers are even funnier.

I suppose the grin on my face is a dead

give away that I'm goofing off. Well, time to get back to earning my bread and butter!

2.00 pm and that heavy lunch is making me drowsy...

I could revisit some of the sites I went to earlier, but last night's dream is still on my mind and I am curious about what it means. I dreamt I was alone in a forest. Heavy mist was swirling around me and I could hear some weird sounds. I think I even saw a ghost. I head to www.freaky-dreams.com. I describe my dream and the site gives an interpretation based on a few keywords it finds in the text. It's not really worth hanging on to, but fun nonetheless.

Here's something you can slip in as an excuse for management training—at www.lemonadegame.com you manage a lemonade stand and depending on the weather conditions, decide the price of each cup of lemonade and how much



Webcrosswords: Crosswords to relax your mind



Emode: Know thyself